Paragate — Narrative Kinematics Report

Generated from manuscript ADT data using the StoryNK model.

Story
Paragate

Units
53

Position Span
571 - 56,806

Mean Energy
19.17

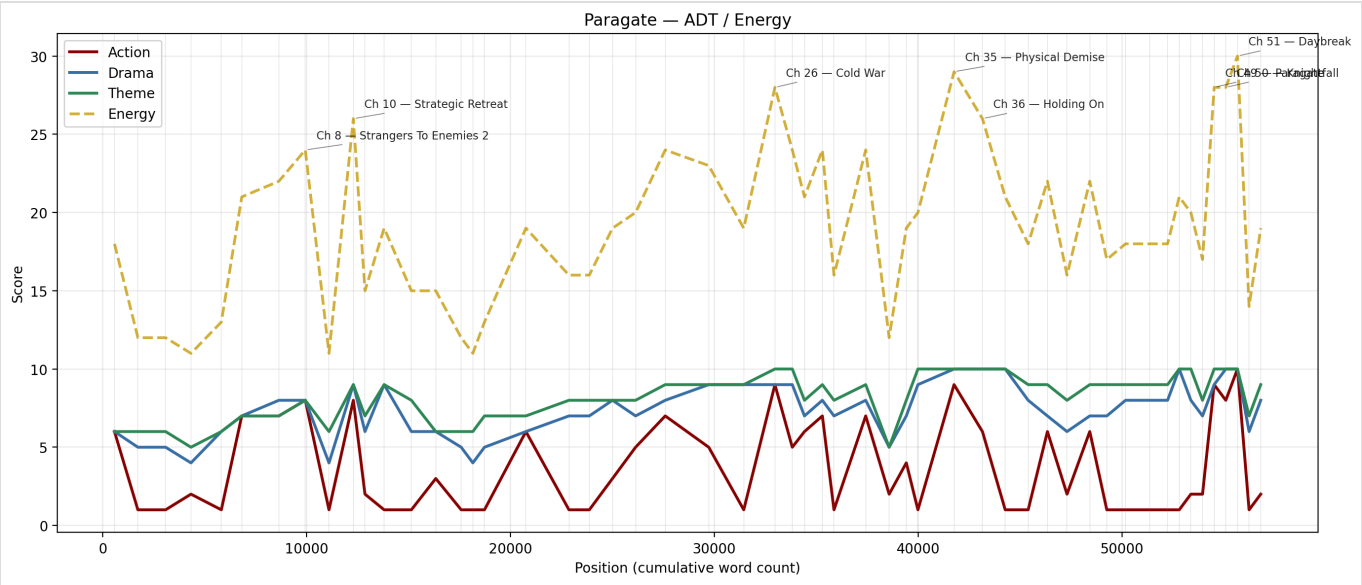
Mean Gravity
49.11

Mean Cut Risk
42.48

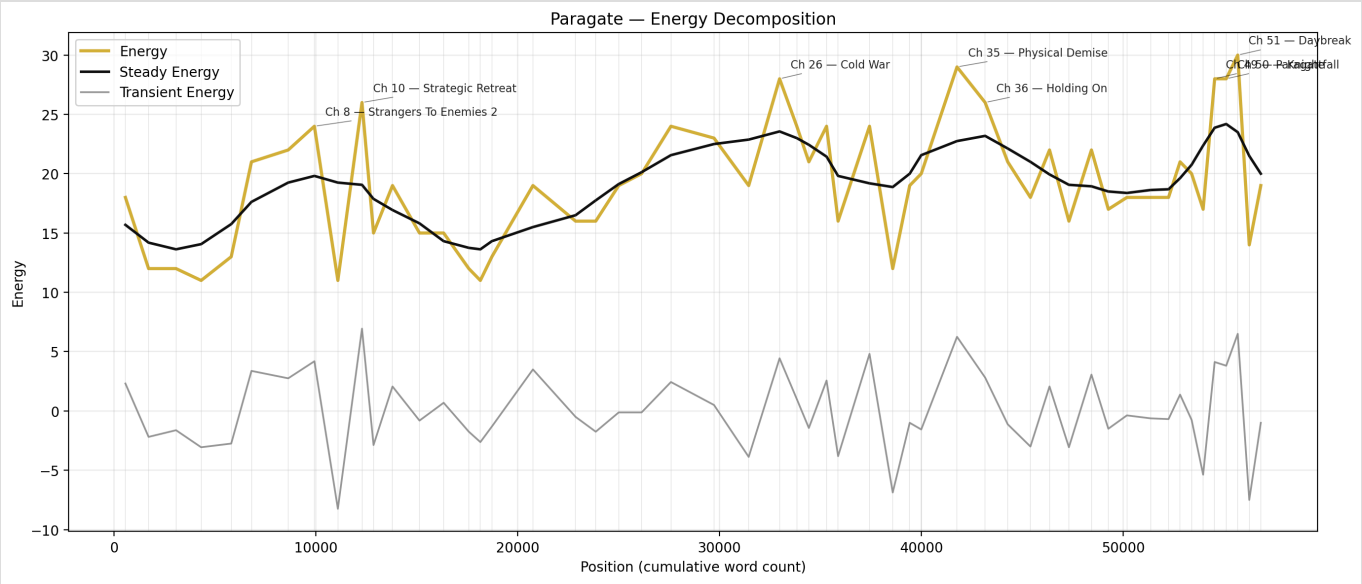
Peak Energy: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Peak Gravity: Ch 50 — Knightfall
Highest Cut Risk: Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

System Overview

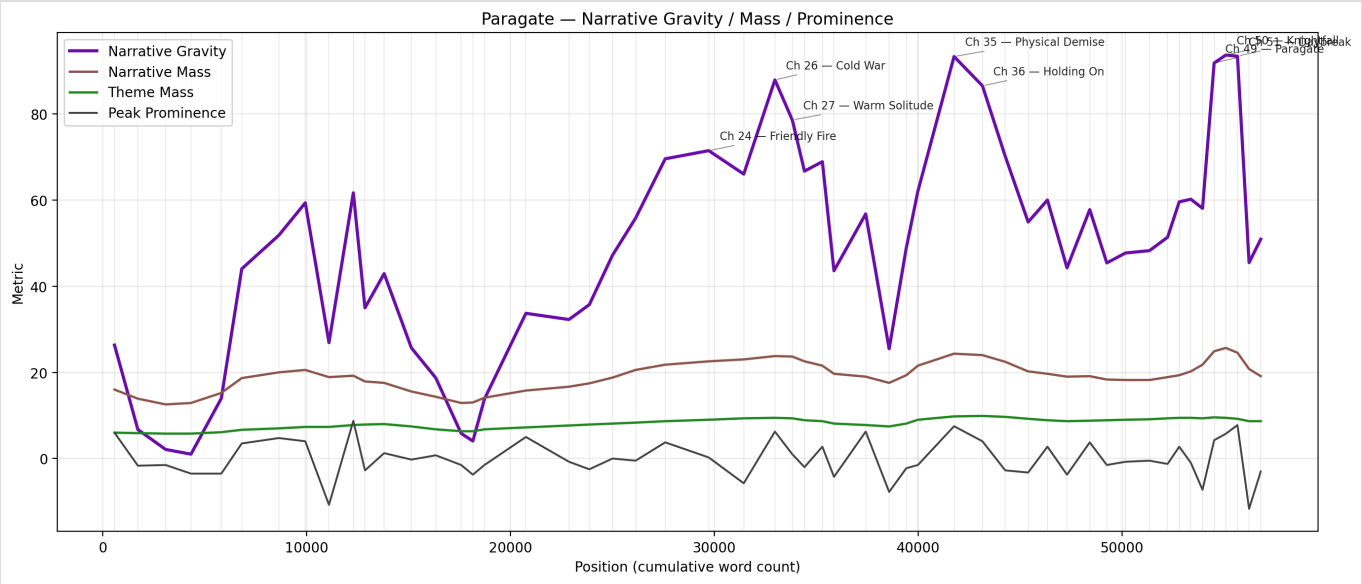
Action, Drama, and Theme define the primary narrative state. Energy is their sum. Steady-state and transient tracks approximate long-wave baseline versus local fluctuation. Narrative Mass, Peak Prominence, and Narrative Gravity estimate which regions are merely loud versus which ones are actually load-bearing.



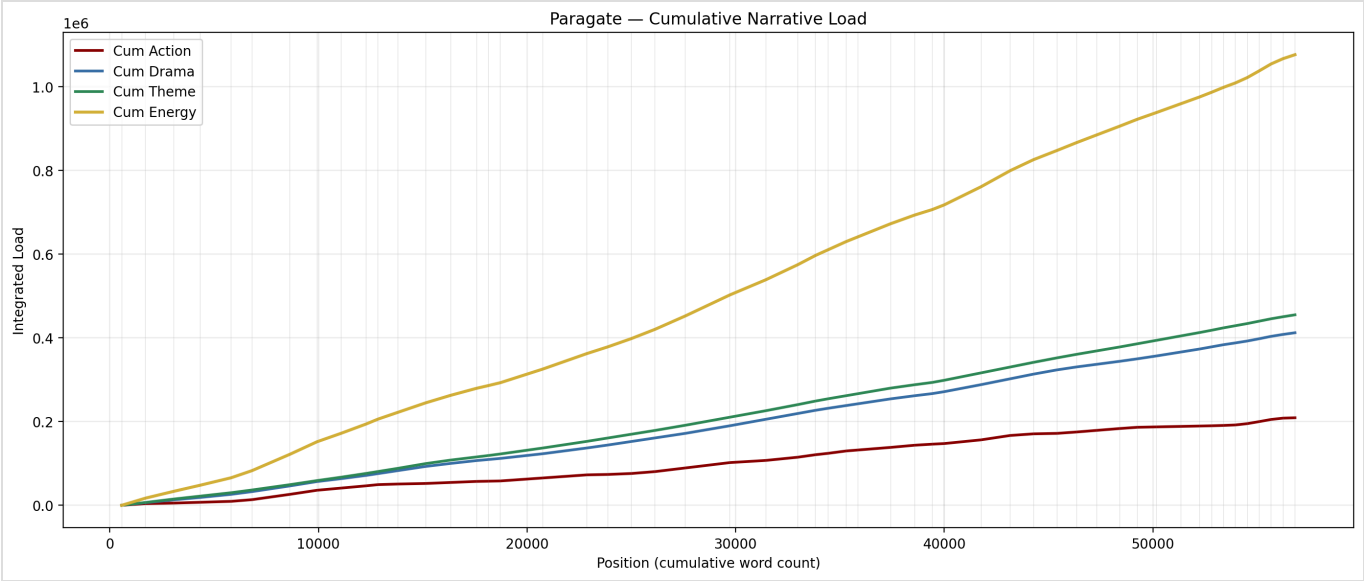
Action, Drama, Theme, and Energy across cumulative story position.



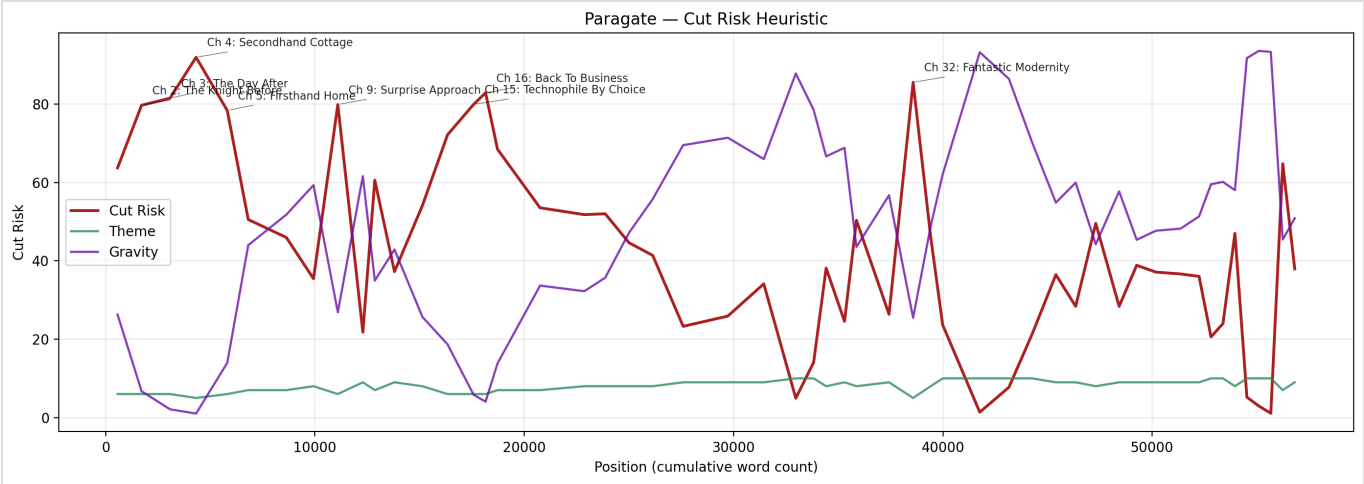
Composite Energy versus steady-state and transient energy behavior.



Narrative Gravity, Mass, Theme Mass, and Peak Prominence.



Cumulative action, drama, theme, and energy load.



Cut-risk heuristic versus theme and gravity.

Top Gravity Peaks

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Gravity: 93.63 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.

Blurb: Winter arrives with teeth just when the defenses start to hold.

Watching the drone feed, Cody spots enemy figures crossing the lake and realizes the defenses are no longer where they need to be. When comms fail, he leaves the drone idling and r...

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Gravity: 93.37 | **Energy:** 30.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Gravity: 93.29 | **Energy:** 29.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Ch 49 — Paragate

Gravity: 91.79 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.

Blurb: Once the truth is seen with open eyes, the only question left is whether anyone can move fast enough.

Katiya brings Aldrin face-to-face with the reality of the approaching threat, and Jade and Aliaki reinforce what she has forced him to witness. When the Royal Knights arrive, Aldri...

Ch 26 — Cold War

Gravity: 87.86 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified | 2015-10-03

Summary: Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.

Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

It's the cold snap that brings him back again.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Gravity: 86.49 | **Energy:** 26.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Kindness and rediscovery of an old passion dare Cody to care again.

The drawing reads REED because he forgets to use his last name. It was checked by SAKURASHIMA, then approved by PRADESH, and now the chain of custody ends in my greasy hands, putti...

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Gravity: 78.56 | **Energy:** 24.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | The Shortwall | 2005-08-23

Summary: Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.

Blurb: Long before today, a childhood dare turned into a scar that never closed.

"Why is it so hard for you to let go?" The question comes from thirty feet below.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Gravity: 71.45 | **Energy:** 23.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-07-07

Summary: Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.

Blurb: One wins the crowd; the other loses control. Lines are drawn on both sides.

Reed's entirely prepared as he advances towards his last slide. In the lower corner, it reads 20 OF 20: even with a custom progress bar to show the stages of his presentation.

Top Energy Peaks

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Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

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Watching the drone feed, Cody spots enemy figures crossing the lake and realizes the defenses are no longer where they need to be. When comms fail, he leaves the drone idling and r...

Ch 10 — Strategic Retreat

Energy: 26.00 | **Energy:** 26.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-04-25

Summary: Katiya cleans to stave off panic, studies Cody's device; time skip: a month later she hesitates during a royal escort, barely averts disaster, is berated, and runs to find Bertram.

Blurb: A month later, a public moment goes wrong—and Katiya can't shake the blame.

I take deep breaths as I try not to let him break me. Cody's gone now. And I will never have to deal with him again.

Highest Cut-Risk Units

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

CutRisk: 92.00 | **Energy:** 11.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-04-24

Summary: Katiya's trauma baseline: nightmares of Hillfar; she self-stabilizes, starts her day, meets Derry & Carmen (Rayna foreshadow), and heads to base with Bertram.

Blurb: Nightmares, neighbors, and a base run: Katiya fights panic with routine until routine fights back.

The next lucid moment, I find myself pinned upside-down beneath a thick wooden rack. The heat climbs as I drag my heels across the floor, my clothes so black and charred that I pra...

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

CutRisk: 85.60 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-11-29

Summary:

Blurb: Katiya's first peaceful sleep leads straight into chaotic, sword-filled "fantasy" tourism on Earth.

Even in another world, I can't escape the same dream. The only difference is that sleep comes faster on a bed that's made of clouds, instead of one made from horsehair and feathers...

Ch 16 — Back To Business

CutRisk: 82.93 | **Energy:** 11.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-05-25

Summary: Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he returns hoping for an open door.

Blurb: A lunch with Dad. A memory of a brother. A door that might be open tonight.

"I think that will work just fine," Reed says. "What do you think?"

Ch 3 — The Day After

CutRisk: 81.57 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.

Blurb: Another soul-numbing office day pushes Cody toward a choice he's not ready to make.

I realize I'm done working on the redline when my hands stop moving. Copying changes from a red-inked engineering drawing to the computer is easy enough to get lost in thought. The...

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

CutRisk: 79.96 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-05-24

Summary: Cody runs Katiya's route in Gaffesend; she tours him as "royal inventor"; awkward Jullian moment; tavern hang where Cody fits in.

Blurb: Cody tours Katiya's world—and fits in a little too well.

"Have you tried an Eglich?" She asks.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

CutRisk: 79.93 | **Energy:** 11.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-26

Summary: Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.

Blurb: Cody barricades more than a door as reality refuses to make sense.

Late Sunday morning, around 11:00, I awoke with my neck twisted against the closet door, my face saturated with drool, shirt missing, and a sticky note taped to my forehead with Mi...

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

CutRisk: 79.74 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Gaffe's End Tavern | 2026-04-23

Summary: Katiya's intro: she struggles to relax, Aldrin frames trainee expectations, and she reconnects with Jullian as they "christen" her new place.

Blurb: Katiya tries to unwind, but duty—and an old flame—won't let her rest.

With every intention to relax, I try to let the peace of this place flood my tense muscles. But I wasn't made for this, and I hate drinking. The only thought on my inebriated mind...

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

CutRisk: 78.41 | **Energy:** 13.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.

Blurb: Drinks with a best friend turn into confessions—and an idea Cody should ignore.

"Since you started on your first day, you haven't been drug tested. What's gonna change their mind on Monday, bro? My work never runs drug tests," he says. Gunfire cracks over the...

LLM Revision Diagnosis

> **Length assessment:** Long and vulnerable to bloat in Acts 1–3, especially in low-energy domestic/world-tour beats and duplicated dual-protagonist setbacks. The final run (49–51) earns its length; the setup and midbook likely do not.
> **Structural health:** Basically sound. The book has real structural peaks, a strong late escalation, and unusually high theme integration overall. The weak point is not lack of climax but too many mirrored approach/retreat beats before the machine fully locks in. Several chapters read like alternate-angle restatements of the same emotional movement.
> **Primary strength:** The ending is built on genuine thematic load, not just spectacle. Chapters 35, 49, 50, and 51 show high gravity with low cut risk, which suggests the book can land hard when plot, character, and meaning converge.
> **Primary risk:** Drag from mirrored dual-protagonist beats. Cody and Katiya repeatedly undergo parallel embarrassment, alienation, recovery, orientation, institutional pushback, and romantic hesitation in adjacent chapters. Even when individual chapters are competent, the pairing can feel redundant and delay irreversible movement.

Paragate is not broken; it is over-repeated. The data says the novel knows what its story is about and where its real peaks are. The problem is that too much of the first two-thirds spends time proving the same things twice—once in Cody's register, once in Katiya's. That creates drag corridors, especially where both leads experience analogous social discomfort, professional failure, or cross-world discovery in parallel. Revision should be aggressive about compression in the opening and middle, ruthless about deleting duplicate beats, and disciplined about making each protagonist carry different narrative labor. Protect the trauma-origin material that powers the climax and the late Act 4 run that converts theme into action.

Protect at All Costs

- Chapter 26
- Chapter 27
- Chapter 35
- Chapter 49
- Chapter 50
- Chapter 51

Strongest Regions

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Reason: Major structural peak: very high energy/gravity, minimal cut risk, and directly tied to Katiya's core arc. This looks like one of the chapters where the book stops circling and becomes inevitable.
Revision instruction: Protect the chapter's core sequence and emotional logic. Only trim for sharpness or clarity; do not soften, redistribute, or undercut its consequences.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Reason: Peak gravity chapter. It fuses battle turn, protagonist interdependence, and trauma pressure without losing theme. This is structural spine material.
Revision instruction: Protect pacing and crosscutting. If anything, simplify surrounding setup so this chapter arrives sooner and cleaner.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Reason: Peak energy and near-peak gravity with almost nonexistent cut risk. This is the clearest evidence that the novel's ending is doing real work, not just making noise.
Revision instruction: Protect almost wholesale. Any revision should heighten readability and line-of-action clarity, not alter the chapter's role or redistribute its climax elsewhere.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Reason: Strong hinge chapter: mobilization, witness replacing doubt, protagonists stepping into resisted roles. It appears to be the true launch into the ending.
Revision instruction: Keep as the pivot into the final run. Tighten any exposition that delays commitment, but preserve the sense of irrevocable transition.

Ch 26 — Cold War

Reason: High gravity flashback with low cut risk. Unlike many backstory inserts, this one appears to carry genuine weight and fuels Cody's side of the thematic engine.
Revision instruction: Keep the flashback, but make sure it pays forward directly into subsequent choice. If any section is ornamental military texture, cut that before touching the core memory.

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Reason: Katiya's origin trauma scores high in gravity/theme and clearly underwrites the climax in 50–51. This looks foundational, not indulgent backstory.
Revision instruction: Protect the causal details that later echo in the finale. Trim only if there is atmospheric repetition or over-explaining around the wound.

Drag Corridors

Ch 2–5

Problem: slow start / alternating intro redundancy | **Confidence:** 0.95

Reason: Chapters 2–5 are all high cut-risk or near it, with low gravity and low-to-moderate energy. This stretch alternates Cody/Katiya setup beats without enough forward lock. It likely over-explains baseline lives before the story's actual engine takes over.
Suggested fix: Collapse baseline characterization. Keep the minimum needed to establish Cody's deadened life, Katiya's trauma-routine, and the practical circumstances around the door. Consider merging material from 2–5 so each protagonist gets one sharp intro chapter instead of multiple soft-launches.

Ch 13–17

Problem: cross-world orientation drag / mirrored bonding beats | **Confidence:** 0.97

Reason: 13–17 contains multiple low-energy, high cut-risk chapters centered on calming, orientation, touring, hospitality, routine, and aftermath. This is exactly where dual-protagonist mirroring can become deadly: each lead experiences the other world, the other's social network, and mutual softening in separate but emotionally similar installments.
Suggested fix: Compress the exchange-tour material hard. One Earth disorientation chapter and one Valenseia disorientation chapter are probably enough. Fold 'gentle orientation,' tavern fit-in, workplace reset, and market/hospital follow-through into fewer chapters with stronger turning points. Each scene should either alter trust, reveal a nonredundant pressure source, or set up a later payoff.

Ch 20–25

Problem: parallel failure escalation with duplicate beat shape | **Confidence:** 0.88

Reason: This run has decent gravity overall, but it appears to stage a sequence where both leads undergo relational/professional/social failure in mirrored fashion: awkward dating, uncomfortable truths, tests, presentations, losses, and then a mutual fight. The risk is not low stakes; it is too many adjacent chapters delivering the same emotional message: both are failing and defensive.
Suggested fix: Differentiate the labor of each protagonist. Do not let both halves merely echo humiliation. Pick one line to carry professional collapse and the other to carry relational or family pressure. Trim or combine chapters 22–24 if they are separate expressions of the same failure spiral. Preserve the fight in 25 only if the preceding losses are not already repetitive.

Ch 28–33

Problem: midbook wobble / tonal diffusion | **Confidence:** 0.94

Reason: After two strong backstory chapters (26–27), the novel appears to drift through improvement, family/romantic material, ominous email, reunion/rescue, low-value Earth tourism, and tournament/outing disruption. Chapter 32 is a huge cut-risk spike, and 28–33 as a block feels like the book re-earning momentum it already had.

Suggested fix: Use 26–27 as a relaunch, not a pause. Cut chapter 32 hard, compress 28–30, and make 31 the decisive reconnection beat. Move to 34–35 faster. If 33 contains important bad news, extract that turn and lose the sightseeing/tournament padding around it.

Ch 40–45

Problem: late planning plateau | **Confidence:** 0.82

Reason: Act 4 should be tightening, but 40–45 stacks planning, new allies, fabrication, alliance friction, grief processing, and family confrontation across many medium-gravity chapters. The content may be good, but the sequence risks feeling like six versions of 'we are preparing / connecting / being tested emotionally' before the lock-in at 46–49.

Suggested fix: Condense preparation. Combine allied-politics material with fabrication progress where possible, and eliminate repeated team-stabilization conversations. Make each chapter answer a different question: what is the plan, what is the cost, who commits, what fails. If a chapter only reaffirms support or grief already established, trim it aggressively.

Cut Candidates

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Action: compress_hard

Reason: Highest cut risk in the book by a wide margin, very low gravity, and early-placement vulnerability. Trauma baseline matters, but this chapter likely spends too long on routine and baseline before plot pressure is strong enough to justify it.

Target: Condense nightmare/routine/neighbors/base-run material to the minimum that establishes Katiya’s trauma management and daily world. Preserve only foreshadowing that pays off decisively later.

Ch 3 — The Day After

Action: compress_hard

Reason: Very high cut risk, very low gravity. Likely another baseline-workplace misery chapter before the central engine is fully engaged.

Target: Strip to the essentials of Cody’s deadened work life, Reed/Kei setup, and home/social context. If this repeats attitudes already clear in chapter 1, merge the best parts.

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

Action: merge

Reason: High cut risk and low gravity as an introductory Katiya setup chapter. In combination with 4, this suggests overbuilt baseline for her side.
Target: Merge core trainee-expectation/Jullian/home-life setup with chapter 4 or another stronger Katiya chapter. Avoid giving Katiya multiple pre-engine introduction chapters.

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

Action: trim

Reason: High cut risk and modest gravity. Another Cody-home baseline scene soon after his intro and office-day material is likely redundant.
Target: Cut any extended bro-out/confession material that does not directly motivate the doorway event or Cody's emotional vacancy.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Action: compress_hard

Reason: High cut risk and a severe prominence dip immediately after stronger confrontation chapters. Reads like reaction/reset after the story had already found momentum.
Target: Keep only what is necessary to establish Cody's denial and Reed as foil. Lose repetitive rationalization and domestic aftermath.

Ch 14 — Luddite By Chance

Action: trim

Reason: High cut risk inside an already drag-prone orientation corridor. Fish-out-of-water material is easy to overindulge.
Target: Cut sightseeing/comedy that does not change the relationship or world stakes. Keep only the moments that force Katiya into a new understanding of Cody's world.

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

Action: compress_hard

Reason: Very high cut risk and structurally mirrors chapter 14 in reverse. This is the dual-protagonist drag pattern in pure form.
Target: Reduce reciprocal tourism and social integration beats. Keep one or two scenes that create genuine friction or irreversible closeness; cut the rest.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Action: merge

Reason: Very high cut risk, low gravity, and likely a minor bridge chapter between more important relationship/world beats.
Target: Fold Alan/Jackson/work-door material into a stronger Cody chapter, ideally one where it changes an actual decision rather than just sustaining mood.

Ch 17 — Onward To Chaos

Action: trim

Reason: Still high cut risk at the tail end of an already overlong corridor. Contains several obligations at once, which may mean none land with enough force.
Target: Prioritize the promise/Hillfar and Rayna elements if they matter downstream; cut routine setup and any soft connective tissue.

Ch 20 — Domestic Relations

Action: differentiate

Reason: Midlevel cut risk, but the bigger problem is duplicate emotional geometry with nearby relationship chapters. Parallel date misfires can feel conceptually clever and narratively repetitive.
Target: Make the two date lines do radically different work or reduce one. Do not let both function as 'this relationship is off' in stereo.

Ch 22 — Losing To Fear

Action: trim

Reason: Not disastrous on metrics, but vulnerable because 22–24 appear to stage closely related failure beats in sequence.
Target: Retain only the test results and rival/pressure beats that are indispensable to 23–24. Remove any rehearsal of anxieties the reader already understands.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Action: differentiate

Reason: Strong chapter on paper, but it sits adjacent to 23 with similar dual-collapse architecture. Risk is not weakness but repetition.
Target: Ensure this chapter advances consequences, not just adds another humiliation. If it repeats the same downward beat as 23, combine or sharply separate their functions.

Ch 28 — Prometheus

Action: trim

Reason: Moderate-high cut risk after two major backstory peaks. May feel like the novel taking its foot off the gas too soon.
Target: Keep the dangerous-idea ignition and any Reed complication. Cut workplace texture or lunch material that merely restates Cody's ennui.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

Action: merge

Reason: Mid-high cut risk and reads like connective tissue: alliance formation plus ominous email. Likely functional but not efficient.
Target: Fold the threatening email and key alliance turn into adjacent chapters instead of giving them a full standalone valley.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Action: compress_hard

Reason: One of the worst cut-risk chapters in the book, low gravity/theme, and placed inside the most vulnerable midbook corridor. Earth-tourism/fantasy-chaos material is almost certainly overlong relative to its value.
Target: Reduce to whatever directly affects Katiya/Cody trust, cultural comprehension, or the next crisis. Excise novelty-for-novelty's-sake.

Ch 33 — Modern Fantasy

Action: trim

Reason: Moderate cut risk immediately after 32; if both chapters are novelty/outing before sudden bad news, they likely overoccupy the same tonal space.
Target: Cut tournament/outing business that exists only for charm. Preserve only the stolen closeness and the disruptive news trigger.

Ch 40 — Reaching Up

Action: trim

Reason: Planning chapter in a late-act cluster that already risks plateau. Medium cut risk and likely broad rather than decisive.
Target: Remove repeated team-bonding and planning chatter. Keep only the strategic decisions and one meaningful emotional collision.

Ch 42 — Eutectic Point

Action: trim

Reason: Another expansion chapter in the late planning block; medium cut risk and likely heavy on introduction/explanation.
Target: Condense new-allies exposition and privileged-world invitation material to what later pays off concretely.

Ch 43 — Harsh Noise

Action: differentiate

Reason: Not weak, but one more chapter of hope-building/fabrication/alliance instability in a crowded late-prep section can blur together.
Target: Make either Cody's fabrication or Katiya's alliance crisis the dominant spine, not both at equal weight again.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory

Action: trim

Reason: Emotionally valid, but this region may contain too many grief/support chapters before the final lock-in.
Target: Preserve the grief transfer that matters to the memorial/project arc; reduce repeated mourning language or secondary consoling beats.

Ch 45 — In Future Grief

Action: differentiate

Reason: Very similar functional space to 44: family systems, grief, commitment. Risk of emotional overconfirmation before action resumes.
Target: Sharpen this into a decisions-and-costs chapter rather than another support/processing chapter.

Ch 52 — Parasmagate

Action: trim

Reason: High cut risk epilogue immediately after an extremely strong climax. The ending may already be emotionally complete at 51, making overt closure vulnerable to feeling like explanatory cooldown.
Target: Shorten to the single emotional beat readers truly need after 51. If it restates that the relationship is now healthy/chosen, cut hard.

Chapter-by-Chapter Notes

Ch 1 — Strangers To Enemies 1

Reason: Good premise ignition, but the high cut risk suggests the opening may spend too much time on malaise before the impossible event. Start later if you can.
Note: Good premise ignition, but the high cut risk suggests the opening may spend too much time on malaise before the impossible event. Start later if you can.

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

Reason: Too much Katiya setup before the central engine earns it.
Note: Too much Katiya setup before the central engine earns it.

Ch 3 — The Day After

Reason: Baseline office misery is probably overrepresented.
Note: Baseline office misery is probably overrepresented.

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Reason: Important trauma material buried inside a chapter that looks structurally expendable in current form.
Note: Important trauma material buried inside a chapter that looks structurally expendable in current form.

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

Reason: Likely redundant Cody-home texture.
Note: Likely redundant Cody-home texture.

Ch 6 — Insurgency

Reason: This appears to be where Katiya's side starts generating actual momentum.
Note: This appears to be where Katiya's side starts generating actual momentum.

Ch 7 — Exfiltration

Reason: Mirrored prologue material can work, but be careful not to over-repeat the novelty.
Note: Mirrored prologue material can work, but be careful not to over-repeat the novelty.

Ch 8 — Strangers To Enemies 2

Reason: The confrontation itself seems to carry real energy. Keep the fight; cut any repeated misunderstanding scaffolding around it.
Note: The confrontation itself seems to carry real energy. Keep the fight; cut any repeated misunderstanding scaffolding around it.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Reason: Reaction chapter after stronger material; likely unnecessary at full size.
Note: Reaction chapter after stronger material; likely unnecessary at full size.

Ch 10 — Strategic Retreat

Reason: Strong early Katiya chapter. Likely one of the first real anchors.
Note: Strong early Katiya chapter. Likely one of the first real anchors.

Ch 11 — Ennui and Excoriation

Reason: Another Cody stagnation beat; keep only what directly triggers renewed contact.
Note: Another Cody stagnation beat; keep only what directly triggers renewed contact.

Ch 12 — Anxiety and Avoidance

Reason: This seems to convert Katiya's pressure into necessity. Probably useful.
Note: This seems to convert Katiya's pressure into necessity. Probably useful.

Ch 13 — The Sleeping Knight

Reason: Important trust-forming chapter, but keep it efficient.
Note: Important trust-forming chapter, but keep it efficient.

Ch 14 — Luddite By Chance

Reason: Cross-world novelty should not overrun momentum.
Note: Cross-world novelty should not overrun momentum.

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

Reason: This is the mirrored version of 14 and therefore more dangerous.
Note: This is the mirrored version of 14 and therefore more dangerous.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Reason: Bridge chapter energy without enough weight.
Note: Bridge chapter energy without enough weight.

Ch 17 — Onward To Chaos

Reason: Likely doing too many small duties instead of one strong turn.
Note: Likely doing too many small duties instead of one strong turn.

Ch 18 — Civillian Combat

Reason: Carries character motion and external integration.
Note: Carries character motion and external integration.

Ch 19 — Warrior Business

Reason: Useful social exposure, but probably not at current length.
Note: Useful social exposure, but probably not at current length.

Ch 20 — Domestic Relations

Reason: Parallel-date structure is a prime mirrored-beat hazard.
Note: Parallel-date structure is a prime mirrored-beat hazard.

Ch 21 — Foreign Affairs

Reason: If this is the hard-truth rupture chapter, keep it sharper than 20 rather than redundant with it.
Note: If this is the hard-truth rupture chapter, keep it sharper than 20 rather than redundant with it.

Ch 22 — Losing To Fear

Reason: Likely one setup-to-failure chapter too many before the real collapse.
Note: Likely one setup-to-failure chapter too many before the real collapse.

Ch 23 — Failing To Launch

Reason: Strong enough to survive, but watch overlap with 24.
Note: Strong enough to survive, but watch overlap with 24.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Reason: Make consequences distinct from 23, not cumulative in the same emotional key.
Note: Make consequences distinct from 23, not cumulative in the same emotional key.

Ch 25 — A House Divided

Reason: Probably the earned rupture, provided earlier failures are compressed.
Note: Probably the earned rupture, provided earlier failures are compressed.

Ch 26 — Cold War

Reason: Keep. This looks like essential Cody backstory with real structural force.
Note: Keep. This looks like essential Cody backstory with real structural force.

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Reason: Keep. Essential Katiya trauma architecture.
Note: Keep. Essential Katiya trauma architecture.

Ch 28 — Prometheus

Reason: Good ignition idea, but likely overpadded after the flashbacks.
Note: Good ignition idea, but likely overpadded after the flashbacks.

Ch 29 — Once Lovers

Reason: Relationship/personal stakes chapter with useful pressure, but don't let it meander.
Note: Relationship/personal stakes chapter with useful pressure, but don't let it meander.

Ch 30 — Cold Sweat

Reason: Feels connective more than central.
Note: Feels connective more than central.

Ch 31 — Heating Up

Reason: Seems like a real reconnection/plot turn. Preserve the decisive parts.
Note: Seems like a real reconnection/plot turn. Preserve the decisive parts.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Reason: Biggest midbook cut target.
Note: Biggest midbook cut target.

Ch 33 — Modern Fantasy

Reason: Cut charm that delays bad-news propulsion.
Note: Cut charm that delays bad-news propulsion.

Ch 34 — Professional Death

Reason: Strong serious consequence chapter for Cody.
Note: Strong serious consequence chapter for Cody.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Reason: Core peak. Do not mess with it.
Note: Core peak. Do not mess with it.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Reason: High-value Cody aftermath/renewal chapter. Protect its function.
Note: High-value Cody aftermath/renewal chapter. Protect its function.

Ch 37 — Letting Go

Reason: Heavy thematic chapter; just ensure it is not emotionally repetitive after 35–36.
Note: Heavy thematic chapter; just ensure it is not emotionally repetitive after 35–36.

Ch 38 — Bottoming Out

Reason: Needed if it truly redirects despair into action; otherwise trim repetition of collapse language.
Note: Needed if it truly redirects despair into action; otherwise trim repetition of collapse language.

Ch 39 — Crossing Over

Reason: Good scale-expansion chapter; likely necessary bridge into Act 4 war footing.
Note: Good scale-expansion chapter; likely necessary bridge into Act 4 war footing.

Ch 40 — Reaching Up

Reason: Planning chapter; keep decisions, cut chatter.
Note: Planning chapter; keep decisions, cut chatter.

Ch 41 — Annealment

Reason: Useful hardening chapter if it materially advances capability and risk.
Note: Useful hardening chapter if it materially advances capability and risk.

Ch 42 — Eutectic Point

Reason: Exposition and introductions should be aggressively compressed.
Note: Exposition and introductions should be aggressively compressed.

Ch 43 — Harsh Noise

Reason: Avoid another split-screen 'both are building hope under pressure' beat.
Note: Avoid another split-screen 'both are building hope under pressure' beat.

Ch 44 — In Loving Memory

Reason: Good emotion, but likely one grief beat too many at full size.
Note: Good emotion, but likely one grief beat too many at full size.

Ch 45 — In Future Grief

Reason: Must do different work from 44 or it will blur.
Note: Must do different work from 44 or it will blur.

Ch 46 — Close Quarters

Reason: Strong pre-storm intimacy/pressure chapter; likely worth preserving.
Note: Strong pre-storm intimacy/pressure chapter; likely worth preserving.

Ch 47 — Ground Control

Reason: Institutional trap chapter that cleanly sets up the last run.
Note: Institutional trap chapter that cleanly sets up the last run.

Ch 48 — Metanoia

Reason: Useful conversion chapter, but the negative prominence suggests some of it may be over-explained.
Note: Useful conversion chapter, but the negative prominence suggests some of it may be over-explained.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Reason: The real launch. Essential.
Note: The real launch. Essential.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Reason: Peak structural chapter.
Note: Peak structural chapter.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Reason: Peak climax chapter.
Note: Peak climax chapter.

Ch 52 — Parasmagate

Reason: The book may already be done. Shorten closure to avoid bleed-off.
Note: The book may already be done. Shorten closure to avoid bleed-off.

Ch 53 — Threaded Echoes

Reason: Sequel hook / wider-world sting is fine if brief and tonally earned; do not let it retroactively steal closure from 51.
Note: Sequel hook / wider-world sting is fine if brief and tonally earned; do not let it retroactively steal closure from 51.

Next Revision Pass

- Cut the opening by collapsing chapters 2–5 into leaner dual-protagonist setup. You need one sharp Cody-baseline move and one sharp Katiya-baseline move, not a relay race of low-gravity intros.
- Audit every paired Cody/Katiya chapter for mirrored function. If both halves communicate the same emotional information, assign the beat to one protagonist and cut or repurpose the other.
- Compress the Act 2 cross-world tourism corridor (13–17). Preserve only scenes that change trust, deepen conflict, or set up a concrete payoff.

- Differentiate the Act 2 failure run (20–25). Stop letting both protagonists fail in parallel in the same tonal register. One should escalate externally while the other escalates relationally or morally.
- Use chapters 26–27 as a hard relaunch into the second half. After those flashbacks, move to consequence fast; do not let the novel drift into novelty or domestic charm before the crisis tightens.
- Cut chapter 32 brutally and trim 33. Midbook novelty is your clearest bloat signal.
- Condense late Act 4 planning/support/grief chapters (40–45) so the story reaches 46–49 with more urgency. Remove repeated team-bonding, repeated grief-processing, and repeated statements of commitment.
- Protect 35, 49, 50, and 51 from structural surgery. The book's strongest evidence says those chapters are doing the heavy lifting.
- On a scene-by-scene pass, label each scene by function: setup, escalation, reversal, revelation, commitment, consequence. Delete scenes whose only function is mood maintenance after that mood is already established.
- Watch epilogue bleed. If 51 feels like the emotional ending in revision, let 52–53 become brief resonance, not a second ending.

Full Chapter / Unit Table

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
1	Strangers To Enemies 1	6.0	6.0	6.0	18.0	26.3	63.8		Cody celebrates his first home, drunkenly stumbles through the adjoining door into another world, is healed by strangers, and fixates on the "cosplayer" girl on the other side.
2	The Knight Before	1.0	5.0	6.0	12.0	6.7	79.7		Katiya's intro: she struggles to relax, Aldrin frames trainee expectations, and she reconnects with Jullian as they "christen" her new place.
3	The Day After	1.0	5.0	6.0	12.0	2.1	81.6		Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.
4	Secondhand Cottage	2.0	4.0	5.0	11.0	1.0	92.0		Katiya's trauma baseline: nightmares of Hillfar; she self-stabilizes, starts her day, meets Derry & Carmen (Rayna foreshadow), and heads to base with Bertram.
5	Firsthand Home	1.0	6.0	6.0	13.0	14.0	78.4		Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.
6	Insurgency	7.0	7.0	7.0	21.0	44.0	50.6		Katiya's first day ends in panic when a distant light (Firebrand tie-in) appears; town responds; on returning home she finds an intruder—Cody— and ambushes him.
7	Exfiltration	7.0	8.0	7.0	22.0	51.8	46.0		Prologue re-seen through Katiya: she crosses into the modern world and recoils, landing back through the

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
									door—mirror of Cody's intro.
8	Strangers To Enemies 2	8.0	8.0	8.0	24.0	59.3	35.5		Third clash: Katiya (assuming Auvryan assassin) and Cody fight to another misunderstanding; she drives him back through the door.
9	Surprise Approach	1.0	4.0	6.0	11.0	26.9	79.9		Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.
10	Strategic Retreat	8.0	9.0	9.0	26.0	61.6	21.8		Katiya cleans to stave off panic, studies Cody's device; time skip: a month later she hesitates during a royal escort, barely averts disaster, is berated, and runs to find Bertram.
11	Ennui and Excoriation	2.0	6.0	7.0	15.0	35.0	60.6		Another month later: Cody is bored while Reed earns praise; Nav spins up a new project; Cody ghosts social invites, but hears pleading through the door at home.
12	Anxiety and Avoidance	1.0	9.0	9.0	19.0	42.9	37.3		FOUR WEEK TIME SKIPKatiya, Ryder, and Paxton rescue near-dead Bertram; she's blamed and shut out—her only remaining lifeline is Cody.
13	The Sleeping Knight	1.0	6.0	8.0	15.0	25.7	54.2		Katiya crosses mid-panic; Cody calms her and lets her sleep; awkward breakfast; they agree to "no interfering" (both intend to break it).
14	Luddite By Chance	3.0	6.0	6.0	15.0	18.7	72.2		Cody gives her a gentle orientation day: first car ride (terrifying), Costco errand gauntlet—Katiya is overwhelmed by the future.

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
15	Technophile By Choice	1.0	5.0	6.0	12.0	5.8	80.0		Cody runs Katiya's route in Gaffesend; she tours him as "royal inventor"; awkward Jullian moment; tavern hang where Cody fits in.
16	Back To Business	1.0	4.0	6.0	11.0	4.1	82.9		Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he returns hoping for an open door.
17	Onward To Chaos	1.0	5.0	7.0	13.0	13.8	68.5		Katiya visits Bertram in the hospital (promises Hillfar); market duty goes sideways; she chases and collars Rayna (Ahkvasan half-blood); Jullian downplays her leap; Cody leaves a treat.
18	Civillian Combat	6.0	6.0	7.0	19.0	33.7	53.6		Cody's volunteer training day: Katiya teases, his mistake catches Aldrin's eye; later he chooses friendship over victory in a challenge—character beat.
19	Warrior Business	1.0	7.0	8.0	16.0	32.3	51.8		Open house at Cody's work: meet Reed & Kei; Cody geeks out, Katiya meets Alan & Kim; they overhear Reed/Kei on Cody missing from the "Future Talent" wall.
20	Domestic Relations	1.0	7.0	8.0	16.0	35.7	52.0		Katiya engineers a Cody—Kei date; in parallel she and Jullian go to hot springs and bristle; Cody's date feels off and foggy—he insists he's "fine."
21	Foreign Affairs	3.0	8.0	8.0	19.0	47.2	44.6		Katiya extracts an uncomfortable truth from Jullian; intercut meltdown date beats (both couples misfire);

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
									Cody & Kei hook up but it lands as empty.
22	Losing To Fear	5.0	7.0	8.0	20.0	55.8	41.4		Katiya passes core exams but shoots poorly; Aryn is unflappable; Cody and Reed clash about what a Level-1 is; Katiya insists on leading the next team exam, feeling off her game.
23	Failing To Launch	7.0	8.0	9.0	24.0	69.6	23.3		Cody presents and gets hammered; Reed's allies redirect the room; Katiya's plan withers, Bertram is "killed" in exercise, she barges the opposing house—bad optics.
24	Friendly Fire	5.0	9.0	9.0	23.0	71.4	25.9		Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.
25	A House Divided	1.0	9.0	9.0	19.0	66.0	34.1		Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.
26	Cold War	9.0	9.0	10.0	28.0	87.9	4.9		Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.
27	Warm Solitude	5.0	9.0	10.0	24.0	78.6	14.1		Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
28	Prometheus	6.0	7.0	8.0	21.0	66.7	38.2		Months later: Naveen notes Cody's improvement but deeper ennui; company lunch where Reed is promoted; Reed asks Cody to help fix his flawed prototype (they bond); that night Cody, riding the high, uses Essence as flux—batteries "fire" and spark his next idea.
29	Once Lovers	7.0	8.0	9.0	24.0	68.9	24.6		
30	Cold Sweat	1.0	7.0	8.0	16.0	43.6	50.4		
31	Heating Up	7.0	8.0	9.0	24.0	56.8	26.4		
32	Fantastic Modernity	2.0	5.0	5.0	12.0	25.5	85.6		
33	Modern Fantasy	4.0	7.0	8.0	19.0	48.9	46.1		
34	Professional Death	1.0	9.0	10.0	20.0	62.1	23.7		
35	Physical Demise	9.0	10.0	10.0	29.0	93.3	1.4		
36	Holding On	6.0	10.0	10.0	26.0	86.5	7.7		
37	Letting Go	1.0	10.0	10.0	21.0	70.1	21.4		
38	Bottoming Out	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	54.9	36.5		After reaching the ugliest versions of themselves, Cody and Katiya finally stop performing strength and let each other see the damage. Cody interrupts his own collapse long enough to comfort Katiya after Bertram's death, and Katiya's tribunal summons turns grief into a hard deadline. By the end of the chapter, despair has not lifted—but it has been given direction.

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
39	Crossing Over	6.0	7.0	9.0	22.0	60.0	28.4		The private crisis inside Katiya's house becomes part of a much larger war when Titus and Sylvia force their way into the story. Cody is thrown into a terrifying first encounter with people from a harsher world, Katiya begins to understand the scale of what is coming, and Cody's attempt to regroup turns into a brutal training date that recommits him to fighting for a future instead of grieving one he already lost.
40	Reaching Up	2.0	6.0	8.0	16.0	44.2	49.6		The planning phase begins in earnest as Cody's world and Katiya's world stop operating like separate emotional shelters. Over coffee, cheap drinks, and overlapping stories, the group starts building a shared strategy. Cody's abandoned project stops being a joke, and Katiya's increasingly unstable home life collides with the possibility that her estranged allies might actually stand with her.
41	Annealment	6.0	7.0	9.0	22.0	57.8	28.4		Action replaces vague intention. Cody begins rebuilding JAX with help instead of shame, while Katiya tries to hold together a house full of secrets, fugitives, and divided loyalties. Both storylines harden under pressure: Cody through labor, Katiya through deception and risk.
42	Eutectic Point	1.0	7.0	9.0	17.0	45.4	38.9		The story widens. Katiya is introduced to Aliaki, Jade, and the deeper political reality behind the coming attack, while Cody is invited deeper into Reed's privileged world

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
									and closer to a genuine second chance at proving himself. Both protagonists are handed tools and warnings they only partly understand.
43	Harsh Noise	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	47.7	37.1		Hope starts making noise. Cody begins fabrication in Reed's family machine space and gains the first meaningful encouragement he has felt from adults tied to the aerospace legacy he still wants. Meanwhile, Katiya's alliance nearly implodes in a misunderstanding fueled by power and distrust, forcing her to stabilize a group that could either save Gaffesend or tear itself apart.
44	In Loving Memory	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	48.2	36.7		Grief finally becomes communal instead of private. Cody helps Aryn and Rayna speak through loss by talking about Jackson, Katiya returns to a quieter house and finds evidence of the care he has extended to others, and the chapter ends with intimacy growing out of exhaustion, trust, and shared mourning.
45	In Future Grief	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	51.4	36.1		Both protagonists face family systems that love them but do not really understand what they are choosing. Cody confronts his parents' fear, finances, and assumptions about his future, while Katiya tells her family the truth about the danger she still intends to face. Jackson's name and memory become fused to Cody's project, turning invention into memorial.

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
46	Close Quarters	1.0	10.0	10.0	21.0	59.6	20.6		The quiet before the storm turns out not to be quiet at all. Cody and Katiya field-test the prototype and accidentally unleash terrifying power, then return home to find official pressure closing around Katiya's life. Their last stretch of peace becomes a vow, a confession, and an act of choosing each other before the worlds move to tear them apart.
47	Ground Control	2.0	8.0	10.0	20.0	60.2	24.0		Cody and Katiya each step into what should be their final chance to claim the futures they want, only to be immediately restrained by the institutions they have spent the story trying to survive. Cody tries to reach the Aspen conference room before HR can bury him, while Katiya is taken into custody before her tribunal and shut away from the threat she knows is coming. By the end of the chapter, both are trapped inside systems that mistake control for safety.
48	Metanoia	2.0	7.0	8.0	17.0	58.1	47.0		Both protagonists fight for one clean chance to be heard. Cody's confession turns his firing into a political problem inside Navidson-Monroe, while Katiya persuades Aryn that the truth matters more than procedure and turns imprisonment into a joint push toward Aldrin. The chapter tests what they have actually learned: not how to escape pressure, but how to move through it without lying to themselves.
49	Paragate	9.0	9.0	10.0	28.0	91.8	5.2		The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial.

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
									Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.
50	Knightfall	8.0	10.0	10.0	28.0	93.6	2.9		The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.
51	Daybreak	10.0	10.0	10.0	30.0	93.4	1.1		Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.
52	Parasmagate	1.0	6.0	7.0	14.0	45.5	64.8		The epilogue gives Paragate its emotional closure before leaving one quiet fracture open for the future. Cody and Katiya emerge from the battle changed, no

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
									longer using each other's worlds as refuge from their own lives, and their relationship finally rests on chosen commitment instead of mutual escape.
53	Threaded Echoes	2.0	8.0	9.0	19.0	50.9	38.0		